

Bazaar

mini QUICK
INSIGHTS
FROM INDEPTH
TESTS

The Digit Test Centre receives hundreds of products every month. Each of these products is put through a series of tests, and are finally given a verdict. The final score is arrived at after considering a number of factors and evaluating them in terms of features, performance, value for money, build quality, and in the case of software even ease of use.

For better understanding of our ratings, here's a quick guide to our overall score

1.0 - 3.0 - Extremely poor product. Keep away!

3.5 - 5.0 - Strictly OK. Not recommended

5.5 - 6.5 - Decent product. Go for it, but there may be better products.

7.0 - 8.5 - Very good product. Highly recommended.

9.0-10.0 - Ground-breaking product. We've never seen anything like it before. A definite must buy!



Alienware m18x

The Alienware m18x has been launched for about \$2000, going upto \$5500. <http://zd.net/pucqF2>

MOTHERBOARDS



ZOTAC Z68 ITX-B-E

Price: ₹12,999



ASUS P8Z68-V Pro

Price: ₹13,550

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset.....Intel Z68
UEFI BIOS.....No
Display Ports.....2 x DVI, 1 x HDMI,
1 x DisplayPort
USB 3.0 ports.....2

Chipset.....Intel Z68
UEFI BIOS.....Yes
Display Ports 1xDVI, 1xHDMI, 1xD-Sub
USB 3.0 ports.....2

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....8.0

It has an onboard NVIDIA GT 430 graphics solution, a WiFi adapter, an mSATA port.

Performance.....6.5

PC Mark Vantage (Overall): 12240;
Cinebench R11.5: 7.3; Resident Evil 5 (1680x1050, med):54.7FPS; STALKER:COP (1680x1050, med): 35.7 FPS

Build quality.....6.0

It has a sturdy build but the layout of the board appears cramped with very little room.

Value for money.....5.5

Priced on the higher side for a mini ITX board.

Features.....7.0

It supports Lucid Virtu which allows you two switch between IGP and discrete graphics.

Performance.....7.0

PC Mark Vantage (Overall): 13970; Cinebench R11.5): 6.83; Resident Evil 5 (1680x1050, med):168.6FPS; STALKER:COP (1680x1050, med): 105.1 FPS

Build quality.....7.5

It has an excellent build with good quality heatsinks. Layout of the board is dense but not cramped.

Value for money.....6.5

At ₹13,550 this board is decently priced for its features.

WE SAY

6.5

Do not go by the small form factor of this board, it can very well be used as your mainstream system with the Core i7-2600K. It is priced quite high specially when you take into consideration the price you will have to pay for a laptop RAM stick (thanks to the SODIMM slots), which is comparatively pricier than a desktop RAM stick. If you do not want to be limited to GT 430, you can go for the economical Z68 ITX-A-E WiFi board which has everything this board does except the graphics. For ₹10,000 we would recommend the board for someone looking to build a small form factor PC with limited graphics.

7.0

ASUS P8Z68 V Pro is an ideal board for overclockers and it's priced considerably lower than MSI's Z68A GD80 and Gigabyte Z68X UD7. It has the UEFI BIOS and supports Lucid Virtu which allows users to get the best of both integrated and discrete graphics. We did notice a drop of 5-8 frames when using discrete graphics and taking the output via the boards onboard DVI port. Existing P67 users should switch only if they will use Quick Sync for transcoding and plan to use Intel Rapid storage technology. We would still wait for the price to drop though.